265 Westvale Drive, Waterloo, ON. N2T 2B2. 519-746-1965

School Council Meeting Minutes
January 14, 2026 – 6pm

Welcome to those attending –

Name	Present	Name	Present
Catharine Marchand	X	Aya Alkabarity	X
Elysia Cloet	X	Vasant Somani	
Lori Burton	X	Arlene Nancekivell	
Tonya Seip	X	Jennifer Benninger	X
Eleanor McGrath	X	Meaghan Boston	
Christine Glidden	X	Sambuddha Sen	
Sheena Kinghorn	X	Farnaz Rajab	
Tamara DeCraemer	X	Melania Vargas Arvizu	
Jennifer Thysman	X	Mike Meech	X
Tammy Lee Hauser	X	Debalina Saha	
Sarah Steinert	X		

Welcome Message – Tonya

Territorial Acknowledgment - Catharine

Principals Report – Catharine

- During the PD Day staff participated in learning activities.
- Term 1 Report Cards come home February 9th, please contact your child's teacher with any questions or concerns.
- A math facilitator came to the school to work on math learnings.
- Kindergarten registration has been open since October. It's really important to get the numbers right for enrollment as soon as possible because staffing happens so early. If you know someone who has a JK or SK student starting in the fall, please encourage them to reach out and enroll as soon as possible.
- French Immersion
    - French Immersion registration has also opened for grade 1 students.
    - Phase 1 of the registration process runes from January 7th until January 31st, during which time applications are accepted.
    - From February 1-28, the lottery and class formation takes place. For those who do not know, if there are not enough French Immersion spaces for all of the children who would like to enroll in French Immersion, spots in the program are granted in a lottery system.
    - Notifications are send to families in early March. Families have 2 weeks to accept the child's placement.
    - Wait list placements start as of March 2026.

    - Visit application French website for more info. https://www.wrdsb.ca/french/application/
- More classes this month are visiting the outdoor education center, camp Heidelberg.

Teacher's Report- Elysia Cloet

- In November the school hosted a clothing swap. This event was very successful. Thanks to everyone who provided donations, and to all who participated.
- Student Choir started in November and they meet every Wednesday.
    - They are working toward a performance at Center in the Square, where choirs from all over the region get together to sing the same song, which they have all practiced. It's a beautiful experience for everyone.
    - To prepare for this, they will go twice to rehearsals at Wellsley Public School. There are 40 kids so they will get a bus.
    - There is also a rehearsal at center in the square. The date is in May, and is still to-be-determined.
- In December we also hosted a Food Drive. We collected 524 lbs of pounds and raised $308 dollars. Thank you to everyone who contributed!
- Chess club will be starting soon at nutrition break, and is hosted in the library.
- Carnaval will take place at the school on February 12th. This is an outdoor day of fun in celebration of Carnaval d'hiver.
- French department are being trained for UFLI, which is the science of reading. This training is happening for core French and French Immersion and involves the for primary teachers. UFLI is already a part of the core (English) curriculum.
- Acadience
    - Teachers are starting acadience oral reading assessments again. These assessments are done 3 times a year. This assessment may not include all students, but all students who fell below benchmark in fall must be included
    - Scores from acadience will be on the report card, but this is not their current assessment. This process is outside of our control.
- Math facilitator last Friday helped teachers to change how we close the gaps in students performance and knowledge.
- Online Applications for in-class at at-home learning
    - Most classes have access to Lexia, which is an online language learning program, All clases have Relex and Fracts (for math computation and math facts). All classes also have access to knowledgehook.
    - Some are quite expensive, so they have to be used often.
    - Students are encouraged to use these tools at home. 10% of the school population with access are using it at home, most are not.
    - If you have lost your child's log in info, just ask teacher for another login card.

Treasurer's Report – Eleanor McGrath/Tonya

- Our financials are always available to review at: tinyurl.com/westvalefinancials
- Account balance as of January is $13965.96
- We have $4500 in available funds (after known commitments for the year). This amount does not include potential fundraising earnings.

- For movie night, our profit was $82.21. This is not a fundraising activity, but it's nice that donations and pizza sales more than offset the cost of the popcorn.
- The video conferencing OWL system has been purchased with council funds. This was approximately $1700 and should make hybrid events better for those who join online.

Carnivale

- This event is happening on February 12th from approximately 11:40 am -1:40 pm.
- Council has voted to provide a hot chocolate station. We have a few volunteers (thank you!) who will be helping for the event.
- We will rent urns that can warm up the water for the hot chocolate, and each student will be provided with a cup.
- Council will purchase and provide paper cups and hot chocolate powder. Apple Cider powder is available for those with allergies.
- Volunteers for the event include: Sarah Steinert, Tammy, Tonya, Christine, Eleanor, and Jen Benninger.

Dance - Sheena/Christine

- The Westvale Glow Dance is scheduled for March 10th from 6-8 pm.
- We have booked a DJ for the event from Thunderstorm Productions, and plan to sell glow items and light refreshments. We will accept donations at the door, but families can attend the event for free.
- If you are interested in volunteering, please reach out to Sheena or Christine.

Science fair - Eleanor/Paul

- Science fair is scheduled for Tuesday April 28, 6:30-7:30 pm.
- Tables have been ordered for the event.
- Tables will be set up in the gym on the evening of Monday April 27th, so they are ready for students to set up their science fair displays before school on Tuesday April 28th.
- Parents and community members can visit the science fair on Tuesday evening.
- At the end of the evening, students will bring their science fair projects home and volunteers will take the tables down.
- Last year they were not placed in the correct spot for collection, and a fee was incurred. Care is advised by the board this year to ensure the rental is at no cost to us.

Scholastic/Cookie dough updates – Christine

- Terra Cotta
    - We will accept orders from Feb 4-18.
    - Pickup is on Wednesday March 4th from 3:30-5 pm. Cookie Dough will be delivered at 2pm and needs to be sorted before families come to pick it up. It's ok out of the freezer for 5 hours.
    - This is run entirely online through THEIR website. Parents must pick the correct fundraiser when ordering.
    - They create a customized webpage (see Current Fundraisers for examples).

    - It's frozen cookie dough, portioned out into 40 pieces. It's approximately 800g. Cost is $15 and our commission is 40%. Meaning we earn $6 per box sold.
    - They also sell baked shortbread for $10 (2 x 120g bags) and our commission is 40%. We earn $4 per box sold.
    - There are 12 different kinds of cookies, including GF and vegan. Nut free and halal friendly.
    - We are inside the GTA delivery area. The minimum for free delivery is $800 in sales. Delivery otherwise costs $15.
    - It was recommended we run the campaign for 2-3 weeks and then it's 2 weeks of processing time before it's delivered.
    - Cookie dough is good outside of the freezer for 5 hours but it's recommended to have it picked up within 2 hours after delivery. The delivery time is plus or minus 15 mins from the arranged time.
    - One giant cookie prize comes free. Additional giant cookies can be purchased for $20 (used as incentives for top sellers, etc.)
    - We can order tote bags through the website for $2; holds up to 8 boxes of cookie dough. There is no commission on tote bags.
- Scholastic
    - We will receive delivery of the cases and boxes on Thursday April 23, 2026 (pick up and delivery are only Thursdays for our region).
    - The book fair itself will run from April 27-29, 2026.
        - Tuesday April 28 from 6:30-8:30 the school will be open for the science fair, and also the book fair.
        - During the school day students can also visit the book fair from Monday April 27 to Wednesday April 29.
    - The cases and boxes are picked up on April 30, 2026.

Pro Grant update/planning for May – Tonya

- We received $750 in PRO grant funding; we requested $1000.
- We decided we will proceed with the purchase of 30 yoga mats, but that we will scale down the number of yoga sessions to keep costs down. We had budgeted $565 for the mats.
- We will have four sessions
    - 1 Yoga Session on May 14th
    - 1 Fitness (HIIT style) Session on May 20th
    - 2 Anxiety Workshops with a Therapist on May 4th and May 12th
    - Event time is to-be-determined, but would one hour in the evening sometime between 6 and 8:30
- We will use PIC funding to help pay the fee for the anxiety workshop, which is $370 for two 45 minute sessions
- The Fitness session is free, as Tonya (a certified fitness instructor) will run the session for no cost
- The yoga session is $90.
- The yoga mats at $565 plus the yoga session at $90 will be just under our grant allotment at $746.

Fun Fair - Sheena/Christine

- Fun fair is scheduled for Wednesday June 17th. Planning has just begun for this event.
- If you are interested in volunteering for fun fair or helping to plan the event, please reach out to Sheena or Christine.

WRAPSC -Jennifer/Tamara

- The meeting included a strategic plan review for the board. They talked about the strategy plan and the learner profile.
- There will be another upcoming virtual town hall.
- EFTO did a presentation about bill 33, including the possibility of changing/eliminating the Trustee role. They are looking at ways to push back on the bill if possible. They are seeking feedback from parents.
    - At RIM park Sat Feb 21st there's an event for advocacy for Bill 33. All are welcome to attend.
- PIC
    - They got more applications this year (approximately 90), and the dollar request was higher.
    - 105k was requested, 65k was available.
    - So, lots of people didn't get as much as they asked for.
    - Based on feedback, the PRO grant they will start communication in the spring for the next year's grant.
    - They are encouraging schools to collaborate going forward. 35 schools didn't submit anything this year.
    - They may also shift the dates when receipts are due to accommodate end of year outdoor events.
- School bylaw best practices were mentioned.
- Feb 3rd is the next meeting.

Spending Our Excess Funds

- We have $3850 in what we're referring to as "extra funds" because it will be leftover after we pay for all of this year's commitments (chick hatch, popcorn for movie night, DJ and supplies for the dance, supplies for fun fair, boards for science fair, hot chocolate and urns for carnaval, and the grade 6 trip subsidy). We also expect to make some funds on this year's fundraisers. We want to spend the money to benefit the students. It was suggested that funding might be best used for things that will benefit most students or that will last for a long time.

- Suggestions for spending the money were discussed but tabled for the next meeting. Those suggestions included:
    - Rubber Ball Recess Kits for classrooms from Marchants. Need two kits at $360 each. Each kit outfits 6 classrooms with 6 balls of different varieties and a storage bag.
    - Event tents (x2) for track and field, and other school events like fun fair, meet the teacher, jump rope for heart, and terry fox. Cost is $630 each for a 10'x10' shelter.
    - A sensory walk/path in the school. This would be a permanent painted pathway in the school for kids to walk on if they need a movement break or some time to calm down in the hallway. Cost is approximately 2k.
    - An outdoor communication board for non-verbal students to help them express a need for the washroom or a drink. Board is approximately $500, but there is additional cost to install it permanently; no quotes yet for this work.
    - Walkie talkies were discussed at the beginning of term, but have already been purchased with school funds.
- Teachers also requested some money for the choir bus trip. Buses cost $532 (2 x $266). Cost is $12 per student.

Next Meeting Date – February 11th, 2026 from 6-7:30 pm

Future Meeting Dates –Feb 11, Mar11, Apr 8, May 13, June 10 from 6-7:30 pm.